

Session 3: Engaging in Empathic Conversations

Pework and Session Agenda

Each mentee you will work with is an individual with unique life experiences, identities, and goals. Making assumptions about any of these aspects of your mentee can create misunderstandings that hinder the success of the relationship. Successful mentoring requires engaging in conversations with mentees that might be difficult or uncomfortable. Such conversations should be approached with empathy, center the needs of the mentee, and result in bi-directional learning for both mentor and mentee.

Pework

Objective: Read and listen to practical advice on having impactful conversations with mentees different from yourself, and be prepared to share your insights and reflections on the techniques and principles presented.

- **Activities:**

- **Podcast:** [Aiko Bethea on Inclusivity at Work: The Heart of Hard Conversations](#). November 9, 2020, Brené Brown “Dare to Lead” Podcast (00:30:15 - 00:41:30) [[Transcript](#) available]
 - While you may want to listen to the entire podcast, we will focus our discussion on this 10-minute role-play portion of the podcast
- **Readings:** **Choose one** of the following articles to read:
 - [Martinez-Cola \(2020\)](#). Collectors, Nightlights, and Allies, Oh My! White Mentors in the Academy.
 - [Benishek et al. \(2004\)](#). A Multicultural Feminist Model of Mentoring.
 - [Tanner & Allen \(2007\)](#). Cultural Competence in the College Biology Classroom.
 - Please indicate on the sign-up sheet which paper you will be reading [sign-up sheet](#)

- **Reflection:**

- What did you notice about the differences between the on-ramps and off-ramps in the role play? How does the identity of both people affect the likelihood of an “off-ramp” during the role-play? What is the responsibility of the person with more power?”
- Reflect on past vulnerable conversations you may have had as a mentor or mentee. Was the conversation handled with attention and empathy? What were the longer-term impacts on the relationship, if any?
- Write down 1-3 takeaways from the readings/podcast and 3-5 concrete actions recommended in the reading you chose.
- **Submission:** Be ready to share your reflections during the live session.

Agenda

- 0 - 5 min – Welcome, ice breaker in chat
- 5 - 25 min – Paired discussion on vulnerable conversations
- 25 - 30 min – BREAK
- 30 - 55 min – Full group podcast discussion, on-ramps and off-ramps
- 55 - 60 min – BREAK
- 60 - 85 min – Full group share about paper you read, actionable items?
- 85 - 90 min – Wrap up